

Skills

Collecting a Midstream Urine Specimen

Quick Sheet

ALERT

- Obtain cultures before the initiation of antibiotic or antifungal therapy whenever possible.
 - A single finding of protein in the urine followed by several negative findings does not indicate kidney disease.¹
1. Verify the health care provider's orders.
 2. Gather the necessary equipment and supplies.
 3. Provide for the patient's privacy.
 4. Perform hand hygiene.
 5. Introduce yourself to the patient.
 6. Identify the patient using two identifiers, such as the patient's name and date of birth or name and account number. Compare the patient identifiers in the medication administration record (MAR) with the information on the patient's identification bracelet, and/or ask the patient to state his or her name.
 7. Explain the procedure to the patient and ensure that he or she agrees to treatment.
 8. To have the patient collect a clean-voided urine specimen independently:
 - a. Have the patient perform hand hygiene with soap and water.
 - b. Provide a specimen hat if the patient's urinary output is being measured.
 - c. Ensure that antiseptic cleansing wipes and sterile urine specimen collection container or specimen collection kit are within the patient's reach in the bathroom.
 - d. Provide the patient with instructions for handling the urine collection container properly: Before collecting the specimen, the patient should open the urine collection container and place the lid with the flat side down and the sterile inside surface up. Before collecting the specimen, carefully cleanse the meatus using an antiseptic wipe or organization-approved cleansing cloth. After collecting the specimen, the patient should replace the specimen container cap securely (without touching the inside of the container), cleanse any urine from the exterior surface of the container with a paper towel, place the specimen container in the designated location, and perform hand hygiene.
 - e. Male patients:
 - i. Hold the penis with one hand. Uncircumcised patients need to retract the foreskin before cleansing. Using a circular motion and an antiseptic cleansing wipe, cleanse the meatus, moving from center to outside.
 - ii. Initiate a urine stream. After initiating a urine stream, pass the urine specimen container into the stream and collect the appropriate amount of urine per the organization's practice.
 - iii. Remove the specimen container before the urine flow stops and before releasing the penis, and then finish voiding.
 - f. Female patients:
 - i. Spread the labia minora with the thumb and forefinger or forefinger and middle finger of the nondominant hand.
 - ii. Use the dominant hand to cleanse the urethral area with antiseptic cleansing wipes, moving from front (above the urethral orifice) to back (toward the anus).
 - iii. While continuing to hold the labia apart, initiate a urine stream. After initiating a urine stream, pass the specimen container into the stream and collect the appropriate amount of urine per the organization's practice.
 - iv. Remove the specimen container before the urine flow stops and before releasing the labia, and then finish voiding.
 9. When the patient returns with the sample:
 - a. Perform hand hygiene and don gloves.
 - b. In the presence of the patient, label the specimen per the organization's practice.
 10. Prepare the specimen for transport.
 - a. Place the labeled specimen in a biohazard bag.
 - b. If the specimen requires ice for transport, place the specimen in a biohazard bag then place the bag with the specimen into a second biohazard bag filled with ice slurry.
 11. Immediately transport the specimen to the laboratory.
 12. Discard supplies, remove gloves, and perform hand hygiene.
 13. Document the procedure in the patient's record.
 14. To collect a specimen from an immobile patient:
 - a. Perform hand hygiene and don gloves, gown, mask, and eye protection or face shield.
 - b. Assist the patient onto a bedpan and raise the head of the bed.
 - c. Using aseptic technique, open the sterile kit as applicable.
 - d. Open the specimen container and place the cap aside with the sterile inside surface up.
 - e. Male patient:
 - i. Hold the penis or have the patient hold his penis with one hand. If the patient is uncircumcised, retract, or ask him to retract, the foreskin so that the meatus can be cleaned effectively. Using a circular motion and an antiseptic cleansing wipe, cleanse the meatus, moving from center to outside.
 - ii. Rinse the area with sterile water per agency policy and dry it with cotton balls.
 - iii. After the patient initiates the urine stream into the bedpan, pass the urine specimen container into the stream and collect 90 to 120 mL of urine per your organization's practice.
 - iv. Remove the specimen container before the flow of urine stops and before releasing the penis. Permit the patient to finish voiding into the bedpan or toilet. Help the patient with personal hygiene as appropriate.
 - f. female patient:
 - i. Spread or have the patient spread the labia minora with the fingers of the nondominant hand.
 - ii. With the dominant hand, cleanse the urethral area with cleansing wipes, moving from the front, beginning above the urethral orifice, to the back, toward the anus. Using a fresh wipe each time, employ the front-to-back motion first with the left side, then the right side, then down the center. Using a fresh wipe each time, repeat the process.
 - iii. Rinse the area with sterile water per your organization's practice and dry it with cotton balls.
 - iv. As you continue to hold the labia apart, have the patient initiate a urine stream into bedpan. Then pass the specimen container into the stream and collect 90 to 120 mL of urine per your organization's practice.
 - v. Remove the specimen container before the flow of urine stops and before releasing the labia. Permit the patient to finish voiding into the bedpan or toilet. Help the patient with personal hygiene as appropriate.
 15. Replace the cap securely on the specimen container, touching only the outside of the cap and the container. Cleanse any urine from the exterior surface of the container.
 16. Help the patient off the bedpan and empty the bedpan. Record the amount discarded and the amount collected if the patient's output volume is being recorded.
 17. Securely attach the label to the container, not the lid. In the patient's presence, label the specimen per the organization's practice. If the patient is a woman, indicate whether she is menstruating.

18. Prepare the specimen for transport. Place the specimen in a biohazard bag. If the specimen requires ice for transport, place the specimen in a biohazard bag then place the bag with the specimen into a second biohazard bag filled with ice slurry.
19. Immediately transport the specimen to the laboratory.
20. Discard used supplies, remove your personal protective equipment, and perform hand hygiene.
21. Assist the patient into a comfortable position, and place toiletries and personal items within reach.
22. To ensure the patient's safety, raise the appropriate number of side rails and lower the bed to the lowest position.
23. Document and report the patient's response and expected or unexpected outcomes.